VJTI Mumbai: History & Legacy

Veermata Jijabai Technological Institute (VJTI) is one of the oldest and most prestigious engineering institutions in Asia, with a legacy spanning over 135 years. Its history is deeply intertwined with India's industrial and educational evolution.

1. Founding & Early Years (1887–1923)

- **Established:** 1887, to commemorate the Jubilee of Queen Victoria.
- **Original Name: Victoria Jubilee Technical Institute**.
- **Initial Location:** The institute began in Byculla, Mumbai, housed in a building donated by Sir Dinshaw Maneckji Petit.
- **Early Focus:** It started with just two departments: the **Ripon Textile School** and the **Sir J. J. School of Mechanical Engineering**.
- **Relocation:** Following World War I, the institute moved to its current **16.5-acre campus in Matunga** in 1923 to accommodate growing student numbers and modern machinery.

2. Renaming & Autonomy (1997–Present)

- **Renaming (1997):** On January 26, 1997, the institute was renamed **Veermata Jijabai Technological Institute** in honor of Rajmata Jijabai Saheb Bhonsale, the mother of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj.
- **Academic Autonomy (2004):** VJTI was granted academic and administrative autonomy in June 2004, allowing it to design its own curriculum and examination systems while remaining affiliated with the **University of Mumbai**.
- **National Role:** Post-independence, VJTI was one of the 14 institutes selected by the Government of India for specialized development and played a pivotal role in the formation of the **IITs and RECs (now NITs)**.

3. Illustrious Alumni (The VJTI Legacy)

The institute has produced leaders who have shaped global industries and the Indian nation.

- **Industry Leaders:**
    - **J.C. Mahindra:** Co-founder of Mahindra & Mahindra.
    - **Avtar Saini:** Former VP of Intel, co-led the development of the **Pentium processor**.
    - **Renuka Ramnath:** Founder of Multiples Alternate Asset Management and former CEO of ICICI Venture.
- **Scientific & Technical Stalwarts:**

    - **Dr. Anil Kakodkar:** Former Chairman of the Atomic Energy Commission of India (Padma Vibhushan recipient).
    - **Dr. Sekhar Basu:** Former Director of Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC).
- **Public Service:**
    - **Jayant Patil:** Former Finance and Home Minister of Maharashtra.
    - **Chhagan Bhujbal:** Former Deputy Chief Minister of Maharashtra.

4. Strategic Milestones

Year	Milestone
1887	Foundation as Victoria Jubilee Technical Institute.
1903	Introduction of the Electrical Engineering department.
1913	Recognized as the Central Technological Institute of Bombay Province.
1946	Commencement of Degree courses (Textile, Mechanical, Electrical).
1997	Renamed to Veermata Jijabai Technological Institute.
2004	Awarded full Academic and Administrative Autonomy.